

Pharmacists Advice Poster for Burn Injury

FIRST AID FOR BURNS



PREVENT

Take action to prevent burns to yourself and others



REMOVE

Remove yourself from danger and remove any clothing or jewellery



COOL

Place the burn under cool running water for 20 minutes



COVER

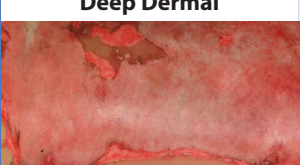
Cover the burn loosely with clean cloth or plastic wrap (e.g. cling wrap)



SEEK

Seek medical attention as soon as possible

HOW TO ASSESS

Depth	Colour	Blister	Capillary Refill	Sensation	Healing
Epidermal 	Red	Absent	Present Brisk < 2 secs	Present	Yes < 7 days
Superficial / Dermal 	Pale Pink	Present	Present Brisk < 2 secs	Painful	Yes < 14 days
Mid Dermal 	Dark Pink / Mottled	+/-	Sluggish > 3 secs	+/-	Usually < 14-21 days Possible scarring
Deep Dermal 	Blotchy Red / Cherry red / White	+/-	Absent	Absent	Surgery Scarring
Full Thickness 	White / Leathery / Yellow / Brown / Black	Absent	Absent	Absent	Surgery Scarring

WHAT TO DO

BURN FIRST AID: 'COOL FOR 20'

- Place the burn under cool running water for 20 minutes (effective up to 3 hours after the burn).
- NEVER** use ice or ointments
- Remove clothing / jewellery from near burn
- Cover loosely with non-stick dressing / cling wrap
- Adequate first aid can help reduce burn depth progression

DRESS & REFER: Criteria for Referral to Burn Service (via local ED)

- > 5% TBSA in children
- > 10% TBSA in adults
- Full thickness burns
- Inhalation burns
- Special area (face, neck, hands, feet, genitals, perineum, major joints)
- Electrical or chemical burns
- Circumferential burns
- Burns with concurrent injuries or co-morbidities
- Possible not accidental injury
- Infected burns
- Uncontrolled pain

MINOR BURNS: DRESS & ADVICE

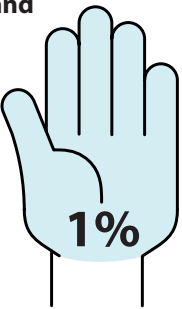
- Encourage GP review for minor burns (not referred to ED)
- Use a moist, protective dressing such as a foam / silicone dressing
- Do not use an adhesive dressing** over the wound itself, e.g. a film dressing such as Opsite or Tegaderm
- Advise simple pain relief
- Explain signs of local infection needing treatment
- Advise the patient to rest and elevate affected limbs, and do gentle range of motion exercises
- Encourage patient not to smoke as this affects wound healing

ASSESS: DEPTH of BURN

- Depth**—burns can continue to deepen over the first 3-5 days after injury.
- Capillary refill time**—apply pressure to burn wound to check for blanching.
- Blistering**—if any blisters or broken skin refer to GP or local Emergency Department (ED)
- See back of card for more information on depth

ASSESS: SIZE of BURN (TBSA)

- Size**—the **patient's hand** (including fingers) is about 1% of their Total Body Surface Area (TBSA).
- Epidermal burns are NOT** counted in the burn size calculation.



HEALED BURN & SCAR ADVICE

- Wash** - keep clean but avoid soap and bubble bath on burn area
- Itch** - moisturise 4 times a day with simple emollient (e.g. Sorbolene) to prevent dryness and itch. Take an antihistamine if needed
- Sun protection** - always wear sunscreen, long clothing and hat when outside
- Scar management** - advise patient to see their GP and request a referral to the local Burn Service



If the patient is unwell or is febrile they require immediate medical attention, especially in children



For more information go to www.anzba.org

